



Deceptive defenses

Short of real guns, the Confederacy turned to "Quaker guns," logs set in embrasures and painted to look like cannon barrels, to intimidate the enemy. Here a "gunner" pretends to fire the weapon.

Petersburg

At Petersburg, Grant's officers urged him to consider regular approaches, but he preferred maneuver to engineering. First, he ordered that the redoubts on the main line be enclosed as forts to deter Confederate attacks. He then embarked on offensives to cut Rebel communications and stretch their lines to breaking point. After each gain, Grant consolidated and then pushed out a few miles farther, overstraining Lee's engineering resources. Strong forts were interspersed along Grant's ever-creeping lines; even the defensive line running along his rear was studded with forts.

Instead of coiling ever tighter around the city, the honeycomb of trenches, forts, rifle pits, bombproofs, and wire entanglements snaked outward, with artillery emplacements everywhere. No siege